

Garmin Instinct 2 Solar

The Garmin Instinct 2 Solar, one of the latest entrants into the Instinct series of smartwatches by Garmin. Garmin, with this watch made a bunch of promises about its capabilities that make it a powerful adventure companion. Instinct 2 Solar's biggest selling point is its solar charging capabilities. When worn by the user in the Sun, the watch charges itself. However, if you are anyone but an adventurer who is out in the open every single day, then you will have to juice it up using the included charger. You won't have to look at the battery levels frequently, though, as the watch during our usage easily lasted for about 20 days, with all the bells and whistles active all the time. Talking about the features of the watch, it features a host of different ways in which you can use the capabilities of all that is packed into this 400 gm package. They boast about the watch being tested to the US



Military Standard 810, meaning it can be operated at high altitudes and be subjected to environments where most of us would break down. Of course, we were not able to push the watch to that extent otherwise, who'd write this? But when we put the watch through its paces, it withstood all of it. When it came to reporting weather, feeding off the capabili-

ties of the phone, it also managed to hold its ground. We also wore the watch on our fairly limited outings to the gym, and we came nowhere close to exhausting the list of activities that are baked into the watch. It also showed our maximum oxygen absorption levels, which impressed many. During our office hours, it was the notifications that mattered the most. And the Instinct 2 Solar did not disappoint! However, due to its screen limitations, it wasn't able to display as much information as a normal smartwatch would. We often had small positions of our notification texts cut out. But, that should not be of much concern to this watch's target audience, as we could not replicate this problem in any other place apart from the notifications feed.

For the price, this watch makes for a great overall package for anyone looking to buy a watch that will last them through a zombie apocalypse. On a serious note, it is a great offering, and for the price that you pay, ₹50,490, you get whatever you'd expect. If you are looking for a watch that would replace your existing smartwatches like the ones from Apple or Samsung, you should stay away from this.

—Satvik Pandey



Noise ColorFit Pro 4

Noise launched its ColorFit Pro 4 and ColorFit Pro 4 Max wristwatches in India this year. We had with us the former and upon wearing it day in and day out for a while now here's our experience of using it. One of the exciting aspects of Noise ColorFit Pro 4 is its design and to some extent its build quality. From a distance, people could mistake it for an Apple Watch. Its squircle dial and digital crown may appear inspired by Apple's design manual. But, when you come closer, you'll notice the central placement of its crown, the differences in its strap design, and the Noise branding, of course. The detachable strap feels nice to touch, but it can get a bit itchy and leave marks after a long course of use. Overall, we liked the Noise ColorFit 4 Pro design even with its expected quirks. It has a 1.72-inch TFT screen with 356x400 resolution. When it comes to navigating through the UI, you will realize this isn't the smoothest screen experience. To decorate the screen, there are 150+ watch faces. So, it has passable visuals and a rather straightforward user interface. Once it's paired, you can use it to track up to 100 sports modes. The list only lacks swimming. Further, you can also keep tabs on other health parameters like blood oxygen, sleep, and stress. As for monitoring oxygen levels in the blood, the built-in SpO2 tracker was comparable to an actual pulse oximeter. The lattermost is especially interesting as ColorFit Pro 4 comes with Bluetooth calling. In theory, it lets you receive and make calls using the in-built speaker and mic setup. At 3,499, Noise ColorFit Pro 4 is for everyday folks who are looking for their first smartwatch. If you're not hard-bent on the accuracy, you would also find the accompanying smart or smartphone-related features as an added bonus.

—G.S. Vasan